BRM RESEARCH PROJECT – FORMATTING & CITATION GUIDELINES

Dear Students,

All teams must follow the following formatting, referencing and citation guidelines while preparing the BRM Research Report.

1. DOCUMENT FORMAT

Item	Guideline
File Format	MS Word (.docx)
Page Size	A4
Font	Times New Roman
Body Font Size	12
Main Heading	16, Bold
Sub-heading	14, Bold
Sub-sub-heading	12, Bold
Line Spacing	1.5
Alignment	Justified
Paragraph Spacing	6 pt after paragraph
Margins	1 inch on all sides
Page Numbers	Bottom centre or bottom right
Colour	Black text; avoid decorative colours
Paper Orientation	Portrait
Tables/Figures	Number and title each table/figure
References	Start on a new page

2. RECOMMENDED REPORT STRUCTURE

Your final report should preferably follow this sequence:

Preliminary Pages

1. Title Page
2. Declaration *(if required)*
3. Acknowledgement

4. Table of Contents
5. List of Tables
6. List of Figures

Main Report

Chapter 1 – Introduction

- Background of the Study
- Management Problem
- Research Problem
- Research Questions
- Research Objectives
- Scope of the Study

Chapter 2 – Review of Literature

- Review of 10–15 research articles
- Consolidated literature table
- Variables identified from literature
- Research Gap
- Conceptual Framework
- Hypotheses

Chapter 3 – Research Methodology

- Research Design
- Research Approach
- Population
- Sampling Frame
- Sample Size
- Sampling Technique
- Data Collection Method
- Measurement and Scaling
- Questionnaire Design
- Pilot Study
- Reliability/Validity, where applicable

- Proposed Data Analysis Techniques

Chapter 4 – Data Analysis & Results

- Data preparation
- Descriptive statistics
- Hypothesis testing
- Tables and graphs
- Interpretation of results

Chapter 5 – Findings, Conclusion & Recommendations

- Major Findings
- Discussion
- Conclusion
- Managerial Recommendations
- Limitations
- Scope for Future Research

End Matter

- **References**
- **Appendices**
    - Questionnaire
    - Pilot study summary
    - Additional tables/output, if required

3. TITLE PAGE

The title page should contain:

BUSINESS RESEARCH METHODS

RESEARCH PROJECT TITLE

"Impact of _____ on _____: A Study of _____"

Submitted by

Name of the student	**Roll number**

Name of the student **Roll number**

Under the Guidance of
Dr. Rajkumar Rayabaram

School of Innovation & Management (SoIM)

Hyderabad

2026–27

4. CHAPTER FORMATTING

Use a consistent hierarchy.

Example:

CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

Body text

1.2 Management Problem

Body text...

1.3 Research Problem

Body text...

1.4 Research Questions

1. What factors influence...?
2. Does ... influence...?

1.5 Research Objectives

1. To examine...
2. To assess...

Note: Do not use different fonts, colours and styles for every heading.

5. TABLE FORMATTING

Every table should have a table number and title.

Example:

Table 2.1
Summary of Literature Reviewed

Author & Year	Objective	Variables	Method	Key Finding
Sharma (2024)	To examine...	Price, Trust	Survey	...
Kumar & Rao (2023)	To analyse...	Service Quality	Survey	...

Important: Mention the source below the table if the table is reproduced or adapted from another source.

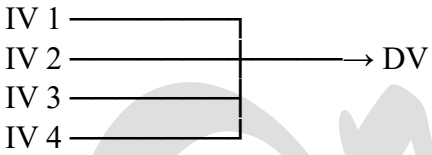
Source: Compiled by the researchers based on the cited studies.

6. FIGURE FORMATTING

Number figures sequentially.

Example:

Figure 2.1
Conceptual Framework



Source: Developed by the researchers based on literature review.

7. CITATION – VERY IMPORTANT

Students must use APA 7th Edition citation style consistently.

There are two basic forms:

A. Narrative Citation

When the author's name is part of the sentence:

Sharma (2024) found that customer trust significantly influences purchase intention.

B. Parenthetical Citation

When the author's name is not part of the sentence:

Customer trust has been found to influence purchase intention (Sharma, 2024).

8. TWO AUTHORS

For two authors:

Narrative:

Kumar and Rao (2023) examined the relationship between...

Parenthetical:

(Kumar & Rao, 2023)

Remember:
Use **and** in the sentence.

Use **&** inside parentheses.

9. THREE OR MORE AUTHORS

For three or more authors, use et al.

Example:

Sharma et al. (2024) found that...

or

(Sharma et al., 2024)

10. DIRECT QUOTATIONS

Avoid excessive direct quotations.

If you use someone's exact words, provide the author, year and page number.

Example:

“.....” (Sharma, 2024, p. 25).

However, for your research project, paraphrasing is preferred.

Instead of copying:

Customer satisfaction is the feeling of pleasure resulting from comparing a product's perceived performance with expectations.

Write in your own words:

Customer satisfaction reflects the extent to which a customer's experience meets or exceeds expectations (Sharma, 2024).

Note: Do not simply change a few words from the original sentence.

11. LITERATURE REVIEW – IMPORTANT RULE

Do not write the literature review as a collection of copied abstracts.

For each article, identify:

- Author & Year
- Objective
- Variables
- Methodology
- Key Findings

This is already specified in your project instructions.

Your approach should be:

READ - UNDERSTAND - EXTRACT - SUMMARIZE

Then synthesize the studies to identify patterns, differences and gaps.

12. EVERY SOURCE CITED IN THE TEXT MUST APPEAR IN REFERENCES

For example, if your report contains:

Customer trust significantly influences online purchase intention (Kumar & Rao, 2024).

Then **Kumar & Rao (2024)** must appear in the References section.

Similarly:

Do not include sources in References that you have never cited in your report.

Simple rule:

In-text citation - Reference

Every citation should have a corresponding reference, and every major reference listed should be cited in the report.

13. JOURNAL ARTICLE – APA FORMAT

General format:

Author, A. A. (Year). Title of article. *Title of Journal, Volume*(Issue), pages. DOI/URL

Example:

Sharma, R., & Kumar, P. (2024). Consumer trust and purchase intention in digital commerce. *Journal of Business Research, 15*(2), 45–58. https://doi.org/xxxxx

Use the actual details from the research article. Do not invent volume, issue, page numbers or DOI.

14. WEBSITE – APA FORMAT

For a webpage:

Organization Name. (Year). *Title of webpage*. URL

Example:

World Bank. (2025). *Financial inclusion overview*. URL

For your academic literature review, peer-reviewed journal articles should be the primary sources wherever possible, rather than relying mainly on websites, blogs or Wikipedia.

15. DOI – PREFER DOI WHEN AVAILABLE

If a journal article has a DOI, use it.

Example:

https://doi.org/10.xxxx/xxxxx

Do not write:

DOI: 10.xxxx/xxxxx

16. REFERENCES PAGE

Start References on a new page.

REFERENCES

Kumar, A., & Rao, P. (2024). Consumer behaviour in digital marketplaces. *Journal of Marketing Studies, 12*(3), 45–60.

Sharma, R. (2023). Influence of social media on consumer purchase decisions. *International Journal of Business Research, 8*(2), 25–39.

Formatting:

Use alphabetical order by the first author's surname.

Use hanging indentation for references.

17. USE REFERENCE MANAGEMENT SOFTWARE

Students are encouraged to use:

- **Zotero**
- **Mendeley**

This will help maintain consistency in citations and references. Your project instructions already recommend citation-management software such as Zotero/Mendeley.

Important: Do not blindly trust automatically generated references. Always verify the author, year, article title, journal, volume, issue, pages and DOI.

18. PLAGIARISM – ZERO TOLERANCE

Students must not copy-paste content from:

- Research papers
- Websites
- ChatGPT/AI-generated material without verification
- Other students' reports
- Previous projects

Your project instructions specifically prohibit copy-pasting literature and require proper citation.

Remember:

Citation does NOT make copy-pasting acceptable.

If you use another researcher's idea, understand it, paraphrase it in your own words and cite the source.

19. AI USE

If you use AI tools for:

- brainstorming,
- language improvement,
- grammar correction,
- structuring ideas,

you remain responsible for accuracy, originality and proper citation.

AI should **not** be treated as a substitute for reading the original research articles.

Note: Never cite an article that you have not actually read.

20. FINAL STUDENT CHECKLIST

Before submitting, every team should check:

☐ A4 page size
☐ Times New Roman
☐ Font size 12
☐ 1.5 line spacing
☐ Justified text
☐ 1-inch margins
☐ Page numbers included
☐ Consistent heading format
☐ Tables numbered and titled
☐ Figures numbered and titled
☐ 10–15 relevant research articles reviewed
☐ Research gap clearly identified
☐ Variables supported by literature
☐ Conceptual framework included
☐ Hypotheses logically developed
☐ Questionnaire attached
☐ Pilot study summary included
☐ In-text citations follow APA 7
☐ Every in-text citation appears in References
☐ References are in alphabetical order
☐ DOI included where available
☐ No unnecessary copy-paste
☐ Sources have been verified
☐ Final document proofread
☐ Correct roll number in filename/email subject

📁 Recommended file naming

BRM_ResearchReport_RollNo.docx